§ 70. **ea** became **ēa** by loss of intervocalic **h**, as **ēa**, Goth. **ahva**, OS. OHG. **aha**, *water, river*; **slēan** from ***sleahan**, Goth. OS. OHG. **slahan**, *to slay, strike*; and similarly **flēan**, *to flay*; **lēa** from ***leahu**, *I blame*; **lēan**, *to blame*; **slēa**, *I slay*; **slēaþ** from ***sleahaþ**, *they slay*; **þwēan**, *to wash*; **ēar** (Nth. **æhher**) from ***eahur**, older ***ahur**, OHG. **ahir**, *ear of corn*; **tēar** (Nth. **tæhher**) from ***teahur**, older ***tahur**, OHG. **zahar**, *tear*.

§ 71. **ēa** became **īe** (later **ī**, **ȳ**) by **i**-umlaut, as **stīele** from ***stīehle**, Germanic stem-form ***staχlja-**, *steel*.

§ 72. **æ** (older **a**) became **ea** (older **eǽ**) after initial palatal **c**, **g**, and **sc**, as **ceaf**, *chaff*; **ceafor**, *cockchafer*; **ceaster** (Lat. **castra**), *city, fortress*; **forgeat** (OS. **forgat**), *he forgot*; **geaf** (Goth. **gaf**), *he gave*; **geat** (O.Icel. OS. **gat**), *gate, opening, hole*; **sceaft** (OHG. **scaft**), *shaft*; **sceal** (Goth. **skal**), *I shall*; **sceatt** (Goth. **skatts**), *money, property*.

NOTE.—1. Anglian has **æ** beside **ea**, and Ken. **e** (**æ**), as Anglian **cæster** (**ceaster**), **gæt** (**geat**), **scæl** (**sceal**) = Ken. **cester**, **get**, **scel**. **e** also occurs occasionally in Mercian.

2. Forms like **ceald**, *cold*; **cealf**, *calf*; **geard**, *yard*; **gearn**, *yarn*; **scealt**, *thou shalt*; **scearp**, *sharp*, are due to breaking (§§ 64, 66), which took place earlier than the influence of palatals upon a following **æ**. In both cases the **ea** became **e** in late WS., as **celf**, **gef**, **get**, &c.

§ 73. **ea** became **ie** (later **i**, **y**) by **i**-umlaut, as **ciefes** from ***kaþisō**, *concubine*; **ciele** from ***kaliz**, *cold*; **cietel** (Lat. **catillus**), *kettle*; **giest** (Goth. **gasts**, stem-form **gasti-**), *guest*; **scieppan** (Goth. **skapjan**), *to create*.

NOTE.—The corresponding vowel in the non-WS. dialects is **e**, as **cefes**, **cele**, **gest**, **sceppan**, &c.

§ 74. Germanic **a** generally remained before the **w** which was regularly preserved in OE., as gen. dat. singular **clawe** beside nom. **clēa**, *claw*; **awul**, **awel**, *awl*; **þawian**, *to thaw*.

§ 75. **a + u** (which arose from **wu** or vocalized **w** (§ 265)) became **ēa** (cp. § 135), as **clēa** from ***kla(w)u**, *claw*; nom.

acc. pl. neuter **fēa** from ***fa(w)u**, *few*; dat. **fēam** from ***fa(w)um**; **hrēa** from ***hraw-**, *raw*; **strēa** from ***straw-**, *straw*; **þrēa** from ***þra(w)u**, *threat*.

§ **76.** Prim. Germanic **aww** (= Goth. **aggw**) became **auw** in West Germanic, which regularly became **ēaw** in OE. (cp. § **135**), as **dēaw** (Goth. ***daggwa-**, OHG. **tou**, gen. **touwes**), *dew*; **glēaw** (Goth. **glaggwu-ba**, *diligently*), *wise*; **hēawan** (Goth. ***haggwan**, OHG. **houwan**), *to hew*; **scēawian** (Goth. ***skaggwōn**, OHG. **scouwōn**), *to examine, view*.

§ **77.** **a** became **e** by i-umlaut, then at a later period the **e** became **eo** before **w**, as **ewe** beside **eowe**, **eowu** (cp. Lat. **ovis**), *ewe*; **eowde**, *flock, herd*; **eowestre** (cp. Goth. **awistr**), *sheepfold*; **meowle** (Goth. **mawilō**), *girl*; **strewede** beside **streowede** (Goth. **strawida**), *he strewed*.

§ **78.** In Mercian **a** became **ea** before single consonants by **u**- and **o**/**a**-umlaut, as **ealu**, *ale*; **beadu**, *battle*; **eafora**, *son*; **featu**, *vats*; **heafuc**, *hawk*; **heafola**, *head*; **heaþu**, *war*; **steapul**, *pillar*; **steaþul**, *foundation*. **fearan**, *to go, travel*; **fearaþ**, *they travel*; gen. pl. **feata**, *of vats*; **geata**, *of gates*; **gleadian**, *to rejoice*; **hleadan**, *to load*; **leatian**, *to be slow*. For the corresponding non-Mercian forms, see § **57**.

NOTE.—1. The **ea** became **æ** before gutturals, as **dægas** (= WS. **dagas**), *days*; **dræca**, *dragon*; **mægun**, *they can*.

2. Umlaut rarely took place before double consonants, as **eappultūn** (WS. **æppeltūn**), *orchard*; **hneappian** (WS. **hnappian**), *to doze*.

3. WS. **ealu**, and forms like **eafora**, **heafoc**, &c., which are common in poetry, are all originally from the Mercian dialect.

§ **79.** Final **a** was lengthened to **ā** in monosyllables, as **hwā** (Goth. **hvas**), *who*; **swā** (Goth. **swa**), *so*.

e

§ **80.** Germanic **e** (= Goth. **i**, but **aí** before **r**, **h**, and **hv**, O.Icel. OS. OHG. **e**) often remained in OE., as OE. OS.

OHG. **feld**, *field*; **feþer**, OS. **fethara**, OHG. **fedara**, *feather*; **weg**, Goth. **wigs**, O.Icel. **vegr**, OS. OHG. **weg**, *way*; and similarly **bes(e)ma**, *besom*; **cwene** (Goth. **qinō**, OHG. **quena**), *woman*; **denu**, *valley*; **ef(e)n**, *even*; **fela**, *much*; **fell**, *skin*; **fetor**, *fetter*; **helm**, *helmet*; **leþer**, *leather*; **nefa**, *nephew*; **nest**, *nest*; **reg(e)n**, *rain*; **segl**, *sail*; **seldan**, *seldom*; **senep**, *mustard*; **setl**, *seat*; **snegl**, *snail*; **snell**, *quick*; **þegn**, *thane*; **weder**, *weather*; **wel** (adv.), *well*; **wer**, *man*; **west**, *west*; in the present of strong verbs belonging to classes III (§ 499), IV, and V, as **helpan**, Goth. **hilpan**, OS. **helpan**, OHG. **helfan**, *to help*; and similarly **belgan**, *to swell with anger*; **bellan**, *to bellow*; **delfan**, *to dig*; **meltan**, *to melt*; **swellan**, *to swell*; **sweltan**, *to die*; **beran**, *to bear*; **brecan**, *to break*; **helan**, *to conceal*; **stelan**, *to steal*; **teran**, *to tear*; **cnedan**, *to knead*; **cweþan**, *to say*; **etan**, *to eat*; **fretan**, *to devour*; **lesan**, *to collect*; **metan**, *to measure*; **sprecan**, *to speak*; **tredan**, *to tread*; **wefan**, *to weave*; **wesan**, *to be*.

NOTE.—1. In Nth. **e** was often rounded to **œ** after **w**, as **cuœþa**, **wœl**, **wœg** = WS. **cweþan**, **wel**, **weg**.

2. **e** became **ē** by loss of **g**, as **brēdan**, *to brandish*; **rēn**, *rain*; **strēdan**, *to strew*; **þēn**, *thane*, beside **bregdan**, **regn**, **stregdan**, **þegn**.

§ 81. **e** became **i** before Germanic **m**, as **niman** (OHG. **neman**), *to take*; **rima**, *rim*. This sound-change did not take place when the **m** arose from **f** by assimilation with **n**, as **emn**, *even*; **stemn**, *voice*, beside older **ef(e)n**, **stefn**.

§ 82. **e** became **i** before nasal + consonant in early Latin loanwords, but remained in later loanwords, as **gimm** (Lat. **gemma**), *gem*; **mint** (Lat. **mentha**), *mint*; **pinsian** (Lat. **pensāre**), *to consider*; but **templ** (Lat. **templum**), *temple*.

§ 83. **e** was broken to **eo** before **lc**, **lh**, before **r** and **h** + consonant, and before simple **h**. Breaking did not take place in Anglian before **lc**, **lh**.

§ 84. 1. Before lc, lh.

āseolcan, *to become languid*; eolh (OHG. elaho), *elk*; meolcan (OHG. melkan), *to milk*; seolh (OHG. selah), *seal*; sceolh (OHG. scelh, scelah), *wry, oblique*. But Anglian elh, melca(n), selh, &c.

NOTE.—1. eo became ēo by loss of h before a following vowel, as fēolan from *feolhan (= Goth. filhan, OHG. bi-felhan), *to hide*; gen. ēoles, sēoles, beside nom. eolh, seolh.

2. It is difficult to account for the breaking in heolfor, *blood, gore*; and seolf, *self*, beside the commoner form self.

§ 85. 2. Before r + consonant.

eorþe, Goth. aírþa, OS. erđa, OHG. erda, *earth*; heorte, Goth. haírtō, OS. herta, OHG. herza, *heart*; weorþan, Goth. waírþan, O.Icel. verča, OS. werđan, OHG. werdan, *to become*; and similarly beorcan, *to bark*; beorg, *hill*; beorgan, *to shelter*; beorht, *bright*; ceorfan, *to cut, carve*; ceorl, *churl*; deorc, *dark*; dweorg, *dwarf*; eorl, *nobleman, earl*; feorh, *life*; feorr, *far*; georn, *eager*; heord, *herd, flock*; heorþ, *hearth*; steorfan, *to die*; steorra, *star*; sweord, *sword*; weorc, *work*; weorpan, *to throw*; weorþ, *worth*.

NOTE.—1. Breaking is older than the metathesis of r in forms like berstan (OHG. brestan), *to burst*; fersc, *fresh*; þerscan, *to thrash*.

2. The eo became e in Anglian before r + guttural, as berga(n), berht, derc, dwerg, ferh, werc = WS. beorgan, beorht, &c.

3. The eo became ea in Nth., and io in Ken. (cp. § 137), as Nth. earþe, hearte, stearra = Ken. iorþe, hiorte, stiorra = WS. and Mercian eorþe, heorte, steorra.

4. eo became ēo by loss of h before a following vowel, as gen. fēores, þwēores, beside nom. feorh, *life*; þweorh, *perverse, across*.

§ 86. 3. Before h + consonant (also x = hs) and simple h.

cneoht (OHG. kneht), *boy*; eoh, *horse*; feoh, *cattle*;

feohtan (OHG. **fehtan**), *to fight*; **Peohtas**, *Picts*; **pleoh**, *danger*; **reoht** (Goth. **raíhts**, OS. OHG. **reht**), *right*; **seox** (Goth. **saíhs**, OS. OHG. **sehs**), *six*; imperative sing. **seoh**, *see thou*. But already at an early period the **eo** became **ie** (later **i**, rarely **y**) before **hs** and **ht** in WS. and **i** in Ken., as **cnieht**, **cniht**; **ryht**, **riht**; **siex**, **six**.

NOTE.—**eo** became **e** in Anglian, as **cneht**, **feh**, **fehta(n)**, **reht**, **sex** = early WS. **cneoht**, **feoh**, &c.

§ 87. **eo** became **ēo** (**īo**) by loss of intervocalic **h**, as **sēon** (**sīon**) from ***seohan**, older ***sehan** = Goth. **saíhvan**, OS. OHG. **sehan**, *to see*; **swēor** from ***sweohur**, older ***swehur** = OHG. **swehur**, *father-in-law*; and similarly **gefēon**, *to rejoice*; **gefēo** from ***gefeohu**, *I rejoice*; **plēon**, *to risk*; **sēo** from ***seohu**, *I see*; gen. singular **fēos**, **plēos**, beside nom. **feoh**, *cattle*; **pleoh**, *danger*.

§ 88. Final **ew** became **eu**, and then **eu** became **ēo** at the same time as Germanic **eu** became **ēo** (see § **137**), as sing. nom. **cnēo**, Germanic stem-form ***knewa-**, *knee*; **trēo**, *tree*; **þēo**, *slave, servant*. See § **265**.

§ 89. Antevocalic **ew** became **eow**, as sing. gen. **cneowes**, **treowes**, **þeowes**, dat. **cneowe**, **treowe**, **þeowe**; **þeowian** (**þiowian**), *to serve*. Forms like nom. **cnēow**, **trēow**, **þēow** had the **w** from the inflected forms. And conversely forms like gen. **cnēowes**, **trēowes**, **þēowes** had **ēo** from the uninflected forms.

§ 90. Prim. Germanic **eww** (= Goth. **iggw**) became **euw** in West Germanic, and then **euw** became **ēow** in OE., as **trēow** (OS. **treuwa**, OHG. **triuwa**), *trust, faith*, cp. Goth. **triggwa**, *covenant*.

Prim. Germanic **ewwj** became **iowj** through the intermediate stages **iwwj**, **iuwj**, and then **iowj** became **īew(e)** in WS. and **īow(e)**, **ēow(e)** in non-WS., as WS. **getrīewe**, non-WS. **getrīowe**, **getrēowe** (OHG. **gitriuwi**), prim. Germanic ***trewwjaz**, cp. Goth. **triggws**, *true, faithful*; WS.

getrīewan, non-WS. **getrīowan**, **getrēowan**, prim. Germanic *-**trewwjan**, *to trust*. And similarly West Germanic **iwwj** (§ **254**) from prim. Germanic **ewj**, as WS. **hīew**, **hīw**, non-WS. **hīow**, **hēow**, prim. Germanic stem-form *χ**ewja-**, *shape, colour*; WS. **nīewe**, **nīwe**, non-WS. **nīowe**, **nēowe**, prim. Germanic stem-form ***newja-**, *new*.

§ **91**. e became **ie** (later **i**, **y**) after palatal **c**, **g**, and **sc** in WS., but remained **e** in Anglian and Ken., as **cieres**, **cires** (Lat. acc. **cerasum**), *cherry-tree*; **forgietan** (OS. **forgetan**), *to forget*; **giefan** (O.Icel. **gefa**, OS. **geban**, OHG. **geban**), *to give*; **giefu**, *gift*; **gieldan**, *to yield*; **giellan**, *to yell*; **gielpan**, *to boast*; **giest** (cp. OHG. **jesan**, *to ferment*), *yeast*; **scield**, *shield*; **scieran** (OHG. **sceran**), *to shear*. But Anglian and Ken. **gefa(n)**, **gelda(n)**, **sceld**, &c.

NOTE.—The above sound-change took place later than breaking, cp. **ceorfan**, **ceorl**, **georn**, § **85**.

§ **92**. e became **eo** by u-umlaut in Ken. before all single consonants, in Anglian before all single consonants except gutturals (**c**, **g**), and in WS. before single labials and liquids, as **beofor**, *beaver*; **eofor** (OHG. **ebur**), *boar*; **geoloca**, *yolk*; **geolo** (OS. OHG. **gelo**, gen. **gelwes**), *yellow*; **heofon**, *heaven*; **heolor**, *scales, balance*; **heolstor** from older **helustr**, *hiding place*; **heorut**, *hart*; **meolu** (OHG. **melo**, gen. **mel(a)wes**), *meal, flour*; **seofon**, *seven*; **smeoru**, *grease, fat*; **teoru**, *tar*; **weorod**, *troop*. Non-WS. **eodor**, *enclosure*; **eosol**, *donkey*; **feotor**, *fetter*; **meodu**, *mead* (*drink*); **meotod**, *creator* = WS. **edor**, **esol**, **fetor**, **medu**, **metod**. Ken. **breogo**, *prince*; **reogol** (Lat. **regula**), *rule* = WS. and Anglian **brego**, **regol**.

NOTE.—1. u-umlaut took place in WS. in the combination **we**, as **hweogol**, *wheel*; **sweotol**, *plain, clear*; **weotuma**, *dowry*, and probably also before two consonants in **sweostor**, *sister*.

2. The regular forms due to u-umlaut were often obliterated in WS. by levelling, as **melu**, *meal, flour*, with **mel-** from the